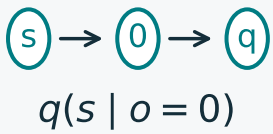
CONCEPTUAL GRAPHICAL ABSTRACT

What can ‘nothing’ mean?

Evidence, availability, counterfactual value and revisability answer different questions. Appreciation does not make them interchangeable.

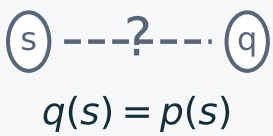


Recorded absence

What did a functioning channel observe?

A recorded absence can be evidence when the channel discriminates between possible states.

A no-event record differs from missing data and from a claim that nothing exists.

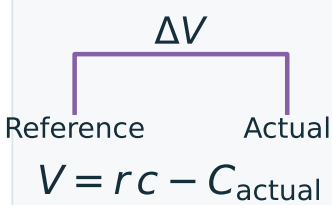


Missing observation

Was a usable record available?

The missing-record sentinel supplies no observation likelihood in the declared implementation.

Ignoring missingness requires assumptions; other missingness processes can be informative.

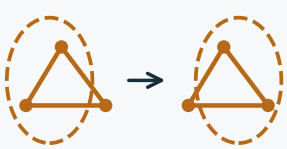


Counterfactual appreciation

Against which alternative is an outcome valued?

An uneventful outcome can acquire value relative to an avoided harm without supplying favorable evidence.

The valuation-only control preserves belief updates and predictive losses by construction.



Revisable representations

Can a useful distinction be examined and conditionally retained?

The finite counterpart tests access, retention and revision; it does not measure realization of emptiness.

Non-reification concerns how a representation is held, beyond recording an absence.

An enabling chain, not an attainment scale

Appreciate examinability → Choose and pay → Gain effective access → Compare evidence → Retain or revise → Assess independently

Symbols: s is latent state, o observation, p prior and q posterior. In the value illustration, r is reference-event probability, c its cost and C_actual the actual cost. Textual traditions remain situated comparisons, not equivalent doctrines; see the atlas and edition notes.

Conceptual proposal → finite enabling operations → a separate human research obligation.